

Character AI and Environment

Posted by u/milkteastudent • 0 points • 13 comments

Usually I'm against ai because of the risk it poses to many people's jobs but I always viewed character AI as just a fun and harmless site for people to enjoy, but recently I've heard that AI like ChatGPT takes up a lot of water. I'm concerned to say the least. Is Character AI similar in harming the environment?

Comments

u/J0ey_Cann0li • 7 points • 2025-07-01 03:29 UTC

Don't listen to anyone who says stuff like that. It's all made-up nonsense designed to fearmonger people into being against AI. A quick Google search will tell you that each interaction with AIs like ChatGPT only takes up a few milliliters at most.

u/milkteastudent • 3 points • 2025-07-01 03:44 UTC

I really don't think that matters to me when it comes down to the amount of people using it. A few milliliters doesn't sound bad but <https://cee.illinois.edu/news/AIs-Challenging-Waters#:~:text=AI's%20water%20usage%20can%20be,per%20kWh%20of%20electricity%20consumed>. Says that large data centers average 2.1 million liters a day, that's like 2 Olympic swimming pools

u/ThetRadden • 2 points • 2025-07-01 03:29 UTC

Dunno, maybe, is that bad?

u/milkteastudent • 0 points • 2025-07-01 03:31 UTC

Taking up water is pretty bad, it takes clean water from people and it recycles it until it gets too dirty. It's kinda like a cooling system, but they have to use clean water because it risks damage

u/ze_mannbaerschwein • 2 points • 2025-07-01 13:03 UTC

It doesn't take water from people or turn pieces of land into a desert. Data centers use closed loop cooling systems and do not allow anything to evaporate into the atmosphere.

The claims about water consumption are exaggerated scaremongering and are parroted unreflectively on the internet. Furthermore, AI data centers consume no more or less energy than other data centers. So instead of watching YouTube, you can chat with your favorite character and it won't make a difference.

u/milkteastudent • 2 points • 2025-07-01 15:45 UTC

You're right partially right but most places do use evaporative cooling systems, hence why I'm asking if Character AI one these places <https://blog.equinix.com/blog/2024/09/19/how-data-centers-use-water-and-how-were-working-to-use-water-responsibly/> Says they use 40% of evaporative cooling systems, while Equinix trys to be responsible as they can, places like Google for example obviously don't use these <https://blog.google/outreach-initiatives/sustainability/our-commitment-to-climate-conscious-data-center-cooling/> Googles own blog says they used 4.3 billion gallons of water in data centers in 2021 So yes I am happy there's been some incentive for AI thats environmentally friendly, which is why I go out of my way to find the ais that are like that

u/ze_mannbaerschwein • 2 points • 2025-07-01 19:36 UTC

Interesting, thanks for that clarification. I wouldn't have thought that the evaporation method was still so widespread, but perhaps my view was a little skewed as it's not as common where I live due to the climatic conditions here.

I'm not sure where C.AI rents its servers. Maybe it's Google, but I rather suspect it's Cludflare, which has committed to going 100% renewable this year.

u/J0ey_Cann0li • 1 points • 2025-07-01 15:20 UTC

Thank you! This is pretty much what I was saying - the people crying about AI "using up all the water" really don't know what they're talking about and are just repeating over exaggerated claims that only serve to spread misinformation and scare people into turning AI into a boogeyman.

u/ThetRadden • 2 points • 2025-07-01 07:12 UTC

Eh, not that bad actually.

u/milkteastudent • 0 points • 2025-07-01 09:15 UTC

Depleting people of water is pretty bad in my opinion- considering that's a basic human necessity

u/ThetRadden • 2 points • 2025-07-01 13:57 UTC

Not that we can do much about it.
Not my problem, so, I'm glad I was born in Europe.

Shit happens.
World isn't fair.

u/AffectionateMovie127 • 1 points • 2025-08-19 08:00 UTC

Average c.ai addict when asked to feel empathy for real people 🤖

u/12bms34 • 1 points • 2025-10-27 17:45 UTC

I use the platform and even this dude sounds dumb
"We're all gonna die anyway so just rush to kill the environment"
Dude seriously

u/milkteastudent • 1 points • 2025-07-01 15:13 UTC

I honestly prefer this answer than people purposely misconstruing data to try and convince me like this doesn't have an environmental impact

u/ThetRadden • 1 points • 2025-07-01 21:07 UTC

It has, but protecting environmental impact doesn't matter, we're going to perish soon enough so we need to develop tech at all cost.

u/Acrobatic_Ad4602 • 1 points • 2025-07-14 22:25 UTC

But at the end of the day the environment is what we have and what we are built on not tech. We can't eat technology and we're far stretches away from being able to sustain ourselves with technology even if we keep pushing it. And we won't progress faster than we will destroy the word that we need to live in.

